

income source,” which defines how income is earned, and 2) The “wealth accelerator,” which defines how wealth is accumulated. The Slowlaner’s primary income source comes from “a job,” while the wealth acceleration vehicle comes from “market investments” like 401Ks and mutual funds. Put it together and you arrive at the Slowlaner’s wealth equation:

$$WEALTH = (Job) + (Market Investments)$$

The primary income source The wealth accelerator

Under this plan, income from a job funds both lifestyle and market investments. However, to uncover the prohibitive ULL within the plan, we have to factor these variables further, starting with the job variable.

THE WARDEN OF WEALTH: INTRINSIC VALUE

How is money earned in a job? *Intrinsic value*.

Intrinsic value is determined by the marketplace and is the price at which you can trade your time for money. Intrinsic value is what you earn working a job. How much is someone willing to pay you for what you offer to society? Intrinsic value is measured in units of time, either *hourly* or *annually*. If you’re paid \$10/hour to flip burgers at the neighborhood grill, your intrinsic value is \$10 per hour. If you’re an accountant and earn a \$120,000 annual salary, your intrinsic value is \$120,000 per year.

$$JOB [Intrinsic Value] = Hourly Rate of Pay \times Hours Worked$$

~ or ~

$$JOB [Intrinsic Value] = Annual Salary$$

Notice that intrinsic value is measured in units of *TIME*. This “time attachment” introduces the Slowlane’s first punitive element of wealth creation. Can you control time? Can you leverage time? You can’t. Your time is limited to 24 hours of exchange. If you earn \$200/hour, you can’t miraculously demand to work 400 hours in one day. If you earn \$50,000/year, you can’t miraculously demand to work 400 years in your life. *Time has no leverage*.

For the hourly worker, your maximum upper limit is 24 hours, and guess what. There’s nothing you can do to change this limit. In theory, you can trade 24 hours of your day for income, but you can’t trade more. Of course, working 24 hours a day is humanly impossible, so 8 to 12 hours per day are traded.

For the salaried worker, the prohibition is the same. You can’t work more years than your normal life expectancy. What is the upper limit of this exchange? Forty, fifty years? In all of recorded history, no human has ever worked 10,000 years of